

Simplifying Cloud Native Development with Skaffold



The successful rollout of an application entails several essential steps. If the developer misses any of these in the development stage, it could make the application susceptible to problems later, leading to rework and wastage of the developer's time. Skaffold automates these steps and assists developers in a hassle-free rollout of their applications.

In a developer's workflow, a wide variety of changes are first made to the code. Then container images are built, which are pushed to a registry till the application is eventually deployed. This entire process can entail a lot of inefficiencies. This is where Skaffold comes in – it helps to manage the developer workflow.

Understanding the developer workflow

This is what the developer workflow

looks like.

- **Code changes:** The first step simply involves changing the code. While you are working on your code, you will simply make changes to it as per your own requirements and save it.
- **Containerise:** Once you are done making changes to your code, you will containerise it to see it actually work. You may use Docker and a *build* command to make a sample Docker file, then use that file to build the Docker image, and tag that image with a specific version.
- **Push:** After you have containerised the image, you are supposed to push it into a registry.
- **Deploy:** If you have got a Kubernetes deployment YAML, you can apply it to the particular environment of the Kubernetes cluster that you are pointing to, using the *kubectl* command that you can see in Figure 1. Once that is done, your application will be deployed.
- **Connect and view logs:** The next thing is to check if everything is working or not. So you will connect